

JobQuest

Finalized Workflow and Requirements Review Plan

APPROVED SCOPE

Steps 1-8 define the first JobQuest release. They cover account access, candidate evidence, discovery, inbox management, qualification, decisions, application preparation, and outcome tracking.

Why this document exists

This document converts the approved JobQuest planning decisions into a clear first-release workflow. It contains no open decision questions. It is the requirements baseline for translating the workflow into pages, data records, technical architecture, development phases, and test cases.

Product goal

- Create a private, multi-user application for discovering, organizing, evaluating, applying to, and tracking job and freelance opportunities.
- Aim to surface five suitable opportunities per weekday when enough valid postings exist, without weakening the recency or suitability rules.
- Minimize ChatGPT and Cursor usage by using ordinary application code for parsing, validation, normalization, deduplication, counters, reminders, and record management.
- Keep every consequential action under human control. JobQuest never automatically applies, sends, accepts, promises, or publishes.

Plan date

September 16, 2026

Owner: Bao Gia Nguyen

How to use this finalized plan

FINALIZED

Every rule in Steps 1-8 is approved for the first release. Changes must be recorded as a later revision, not treated as an unresolved decision.

Implementation sequence

- Use this document to define the page map and user flows.
- Translate each requirement into data records, validations, permissions, services, and audit events.
- Define technical architecture and development phases with a completion gate for every step.
- Create tests from the acceptance criteria before a step is considered complete.

Complete first-release workflow

Step	Stage	Outcome
1	Authentication	Secure verified account access
2	Candidate profile and evidence	Approved source of truth for skills, experience, projects, and preferences
3	Opportunity discovery	Automatic and manual intake by source
4	Opportunity inbox	Clean, deduplicated, reviewable records in separate job and freelance views
5	Evaluation and qualification	Transparent 100-point match analysis
6	Decision	Prepare, research, save, skip, or archive
7	Application preparation	Human-approved resume, cover letter, or freelance proposal package
8	Application tracking	Manual response, interview, assessment, offer, and outcome tracking

Deferred expansion

Steps 9-14 remain reserved for the later project-management expansion: client requirements and scope, project conversion, delivery, client review, publishing and handoff, and analytics. They are outside the current implementation baseline and will be reviewed after Steps 1-8 are completed.

NUMBERING RULE

New crucial features beyond the existing 14-step lifecycle begin at Step 15. The final addendum controls how those steps are added.

Step 1 - Authentication

FINALIZED

PURPOSE	BEGINS WITH	ENDS WITH	PRIMARY CONTROL
Provide standard account access and protect private records.	A visitor without a valid session	A verified authenticated user enters the dashboard	Application code

Required functions

Function	Final requirement
Register	Registration is open to anyone. Collect name, unique email address, and password.
Email verification	Send a short-lived verification link. Dashboard access is blocked until the email address is verified.
Login	Authenticate a verified email and password and create a secure session.
Logout	End the current session and return to login.
Forgot/reset password	Send a short-lived, single-use reset link; store the new password securely; invalidate the reset token and every existing session.
Protected routes	Reject unauthenticated or unverified access to dashboard pages and private API routes.
Record ownership	Limit every profile, opportunity, document, application, and activity query to the signed-in user.

Boundaries

- Email and password authentication only for the first release.
- No AI is used for authentication.
- Social login, multi-factor authentication, organizations, teams, and complex roles are outside the first release.

Acceptance criteria

- A user can register, verify email, log in, log out, request a reset, and set a new password.
- Invalid, used, or expired verification and reset links fail safely.
- A password reset immediately invalidates all prior sessions.
- One user cannot read or modify another user's data.

Step 2 - Candidate profile and evidence base

FINALIZED

PURPOSE	BEGINS WITH	ENDS WITH	PRIMARY CONTROL
Create the verified source of truth used for matching and applications.	A verified user begins onboarding	A confirmed profile can support discovery, scoring, and drafting	User approval of every material fact

MANDATORY START

Every user must upload a master resume containing their full skills and experience and a reusable cover-letter template before applications can be prepared.

Profile sections

Section	Final requirement
Master resume	Required upload. Extract possible experience, skills, education, tools, and metrics as draft facts.
Cover-letter template	Required upload. Store as the reusable starting point for tailored letters.
Work history	Employers or clients, titles, dates, employment type, responsibilities, achievements, metrics, industries, and tools.
Projects	Portfolio, client, freelance, personal, and in-progress projects with role, stack, contribution, results, dates, and links.
Skills	Technical, professional, domain, and transferable skills linked to evidence where available.
Education and credentials	Education, courses, certifications, licences, completion state, and expiration where applicable.
Preferences	Target roles/projects, location, work arrangement, schedule, compensation, availability, and exclusions.
Application assets	Approved reusable bullets, portfolio summaries, resume versions, and cover-letter material.

How information is added

- Resume, cover-letter, portfolio, project descriptions, and manually pasted material may be parsed into draft facts.
- Every extracted fact must be reviewed as Confirmed, Corrected, Needs Evidence, Outdated, or Rejected.
- Manual entry and editing remain available for every section.
- External evidence may suggest facts later but cannot approve them automatically.

Step 2 - Evidence, versions, and safeguards

FINALIZED

Evidence rules

- Important skills should point to employment, project, education, credential, or approved document evidence.
- Projects count as relevant experience when they prove the required capability. They must remain truthfully labelled as client, freelance, portfolio, personal, or in-progress work.
- A Shopify project that migrated an Etsy store can support an e-commerce migration requirement because the work performed is relevant evidence.
- In-progress or learning work cannot be described as completed or professional employment.
- Unconfirmed facts cannot be used as application claims.

Records and outputs

Record/output	Use
Experience, Skill, Project	Structured capability facts with dates, status, evidence, and links.
Skill evidence	Connect a skill to an experience, project, education item, credential, or document.
Preference	Drive discovery filters and fit rules.
Document	Store required source files, approved reusable content, and tailored outputs.
Profile version	Preserve the confirmed facts available when an evaluation or application was created.
Search Profile	Compact target roles, primary skills, location, work arrangement, compensation, and exclusions for Step 3.
Evidence Package	Only the approved experience, projects, achievements, and facts relevant to one Step 7 application.

Acceptance criteria

- The required master resume and cover-letter template are present before Step 7.
- Every material match shows evidence or explicitly states that evidence is missing.
- Profile edits create new versions and do not rewrite past evaluations or submitted applications.
- Users can add, edit, archive, and restore profile records without AI.
- Sensitive personal data is excluded from ChatGPT discovery prompts.

Step 3 - Opportunity discovery

FINALIZED

PURPOSE	BEGINS WITH	ENDS WITH	PRIMARY CONTROL
Find recent job and freelance postings and deliver them to JobQuest.	A source publishes or recommends an opportunity	A candidate import reaches the correct inbox	Hybrid automatic and manual intake

Discovery schedule and target

- ChatGPT discovery runs Monday through Friday.
- The daily target is five total suitable opportunities across employment and freelance work.
- Employment and freelance results remain separate records and enter separate inbox views.
- A posting must be fewer than five business days old when discovered.
- If fewer than five valid postings exist, show the actual count; never backfill with older or unsuitable records.

Source-by-source intake

Source	Method	How it reaches JobQuest
ChatGPT public web	Bulk paste	Run one focused weekday search from the compact Search Profile and paste the structured results into JobQuest.
Indeed	Automatic email	Approved Gmail alert forwards to Resend inbound; webhook creates candidate records.
LinkedIn	Automatic email	Use forwarded alerts; do not scrape a logged-in account.
Job Bank	Automatic email	Forward alerts and parse available listing data.
City of Toronto	Automatic email	Forward alerts and classify as government roles.
Upwork	Manual	Use Quick Capture for promising postings.
Fiverr	Manual	Use Quick Capture for promising briefs.
Other websites	Manual	Paste URL and content or enter available details.

HUMAN CONTROL

Discovery never means applying. Step 3 cannot submit, contact, accept, promise, or publish.

Step 3 - Intake, limits, and reliability

FINALIZED

Automatic email-alert flow

Order	System	Action
1	Job source	Sends an approved alert to Gmail.
2	Gmail	A source-specific filter forwards only the matching alert.
3	Resend inbound	Receives the forwarded copy and emits a verified email.received webhook.
4	JobQuest	Retrieves the email, verifies the sender/source, sanitizes content, and records the inbound email ID.
5	Source parser	Extracts listings with deterministic code and records parsing errors.
6	Inbox	Saves candidates to the appropriate job or freelance view and flags missing or uncertain data.

Resend usage controls

- Use the free plan initially: received and sent emails share 100 per day and 3,000 per month.
- Count each received alert email, even when it contains multiple postings.
- Display daily and monthly counters in JobQuest and warn at 80% of either allowance.
- Forward approved alert senders only; the original email remains in Gmail.

Reliability and security

- Verify webhook signatures and make retries idempotent using the inbound email ID.
- Sanitize HTML and never execute scripts, links, or instructions from an email.
- Preserve the original input and show failed or unrecognized messages for review.
- Detect source-format changes and report parser failures.
- Direct ChatGPT integration is postponed; bulk paste is the finalized first-release method.

Acceptance criteria

- Supported alerts create one or more candidates without AI.
- A ChatGPT result containing up to five postings imports in one action with imported, duplicate, and invalid counts.
- Manual Quick Capture can be completed in under one minute.
- Invalid inputs produce a visible error or Needs Attention item; no silent data loss occurs.

Step 4 - Opportunity inbox and record management

FINALIZED

PURPOSE	BEGINS WITH	ENDS WITH	PRIMARY CONTROL
Turn candidate imports into organized, reviewable opportunity records.	A candidate arrives from Step 3	A clean record is Ready for Evaluation	Application code plus manual review

SEPARATE VIEWS

Jobs and freelance opportunities use separate inbox views. They may share one underlying opportunity model, but users do not review them in one combined queue.

Core functions

Function	Final requirement
Create record	Convert every usable import into a record owned by the authenticated user.
Preserve original	Keep the source email, pasted text, uploaded posting, or import payload unchanged as evidence.
Normalize and edit	Map source formats into consistent fields while preserving unknown values; corrections change only the working copy.
Optional uploads	Allow posting, resume, cover-letter, and supporting uploads or manual entry. Opportunity attachments are never required.
Notes and tags	Record user observations and labels without AI.
Search, filter, sort	Find records by text, source, type, status, date, location, and other fields.
Activity history	Record imports, edits, merges, decisions, status changes, archives, restores, and deletion.
Archive and delete	Archive indefinitely until the user restores or explicitly deletes the record. Deletion requires confirmation.

First-release boundary

- No bulk status, archive, tag, or other bulk actions.
- Step 4 does not calculate suitability, create the final score, prepare documents, or submit anything.

Step 4 - Statuses, duplicates, and completion

FINALIZED

Statuses

Status	Meaning
New	Imported but not yet reviewed.
Needs Attention	Missing, invalid, uncertain, or parser-affected information requires action.
In Review	The working record is being checked or corrected.
Ready for Evaluation	Enough information exists to enter Step 5.
Saved for Later	Valid but deferred under the Step 6 review-date rule.
Archived	Removed from active views but retained until explicit deletion.

Duplicate handling

Case	Treatment
Exact duplicate	Match platform ID, canonical URL, or source plus posting ID. Attach the new source to the existing opportunity.
Possible duplicate	Flag similar employer/client, title, location, or description and require the user to keep separate or merge.
Merge	Preserve all original descriptions, URLs, notes, uploads, and sources; use the earliest discovery date and log the merge.
Archived match	Do not recreate as new. Attach the new source or flag it for review.

Classification

- Primary type: Freelance Project, Contract Role, Permanent Role, Government Role, Internship, or Unknown.
- Employment detail: hourly, fixed-price, full-time, part-time, temporary, seasonal, contract, or unknown.
- Work arrangement: remote, hybrid, on-site, or unknown.

Acceptance criteria

- Every candidate becomes an opportunity or visible import error.
- Original source content remains unchanged while the working copy can be corrected.
- Exact duplicates do not create separate active records; possible duplicates require confirmation.
- Records can be searched, filtered, sorted, archived, restored, and explicitly deleted.
- Step 4 consumes no ChatGPT or Cursor tokens.

Step 5 - Opportunity evaluation and qualification

FINALIZED

PURPOSE	BEGINS WITH	ENDS WITH	PRIMARY CONTROL
Determine whether an opportunity is realistic, valuable, and worth pursuing.	A record is Ready for Evaluation	A transparent score, explanation, gaps, risks, and recommendation	Rules first; AI per opportunity

PASSING SCORE The evaluation uses one 100-point framework. A score of 75 or higher qualifies the opportunity to move toward application preparation; the user still makes the final decision.

Shared scoring framework

Category	Employment interpretation	Freelance interpretation
Skills and evidence	Required technologies and professional skills	Skills required to deliver the project
Relevant experience	Employment plus comparable project evidence	Client, freelance, portfolio, project, and comparable employment evidence
Requirements	Location, work arrangement, schedule, credentials, and work authorization	Scope, availability, deadline, and deliverables
Compensation	Salary, hourly pay, and benefits	Budget, estimated hours, and project value
Risk	Employer and posting concerns	Client, scope, payment, and delivery concerns

Qualification rules

- No factor is an automatic disqualifier in the first release.
- Suspected ghost postings are flagged as a risk because JobQuest cannot reliably prove that a posting is a ghost job.
- Every score must identify supporting profile evidence, missing evidence, assumptions, gaps, risks, and the recommended next action.
- Projects are matched by work performed, not by title alone.
- Evaluation is saved with the profile version, scoring inputs, output, and timestamp.

Step 5 - AI use and evaluation output

FINALIZED

AI execution rule

- AI analysis runs per opportunity when the user chooses to evaluate it for application.
- AI does not run separately for every field and does not analyze every imported inbox item.
- The AI may interpret requirements and draft explanations only from the posting and confirmed Candidate Profile facts.
- Application code performs deterministic validations, data retrieval, score storage, versioning, and audit history.

Required output

Output	Requirement
Overall score	0-100 with the 75-point threshold clearly shown.
Category scores	Skills/evidence, relevant experience, requirements, compensation, and risk.
Strengths	Matched requirements with direct supporting evidence.
Gaps	Missing, uncertain, unsupported, or learning-required requirements.
Risk flags	Posting quality, scope, deadline, compensation, client/employer, and ghost-posting concerns.
Research questions	Facts the user should verify before applying.
Recommendation	Prepare Application, Needs Research, Save for Later, Skip, or Archive - advisory only.

Acceptance criteria

- Every displayed score has an explanation and evidence trail.
- No unconfirmed profile fact is treated as proof.
- A 75+ score is marked qualified but never triggers an application automatically.
- A lower score remains reviewable and can be overridden with a recorded reason.
- Re-evaluation creates a new version rather than overwriting the prior result.

Step 6 - Decision

FINALIZED

PURPOSE	BEGINS WITH	ENDS WITH	PRIMARY CONTROL
Record the user's decision after reviewing the evaluation.	A completed Step 5 evaluation	A current next action with history and timing	User decides

Available decisions

Decision	Final result
Prepare Application	Move the opportunity into Step 7.
Needs Research	Keep active, save research questions, and create a notification for 14 days later.
Save for Later	Use the posting deadline as the review date; if none exists, default to 14 days after saving.
Skip	Record a standardized reason and optional comment, then remove from the active application queue.
Archive	Retain the full record and history outside active views until restored or explicitly deleted.

Skip reasons

- Skills or technology mismatch; Experience mismatch; Location or work-arrangement mismatch; Schedule or availability conflict; Compensation or budget too low; Deadline passed or too close; Requirements unclear or excessive; Suspicious or low-quality posting; Duplicate; No longer interested; Other.

Decision rules

- A comment is allowed for every skip reason and required when Other is selected.
- The final decision is always manual, even when the system recommends an action.
- Warn when a deadline has passed; do not silently change the user's decision.
- Decisions may be changed later without deleting the prior decision history.
- Only Prepare Application enters Step 7.

Acceptance criteria

- Every evaluated opportunity has exactly one current decision and a visible decision history.
- Needs Research and Save for Later calculate their required dates consistently.
- Skip and Archive preserve source evidence.
- Overrides record both the recommendation and the user's chosen decision.

Step 7 - Application preparation

FINALIZED

PURPOSE	BEGINS WITH	ENDS WITH	PRIMARY CONTROL
Prepare accurate, tailored material for a selected opportunity.	The decision is Prepare Application	A human-approved package is ready for manual submission	AI-assisted drafting; user approval

Required source material

- Master resume, reusable cover-letter template, confirmed experience, confirmed skills, portfolio/project evidence, the full posting, and the Step 5 evaluation.
- The user may add opportunity-specific resume, cover-letter, posting, or supporting uploads; these are optional.

Preparation paths

Path	Required package
Employment	Tailored resume, tailored cover letter, required-question answers, selected evidence, submission checklist, and PDF outputs.
Freelance	Selected portfolio evidence, proposal draft, deliverables, time estimate, manually approved price, assumptions, questions, and PDF output when useful.

Document rules

- PDF is the required first-release output format.
- Tailoring uses the master resume and cover-letter template as controlled sources.
- Projects are matched by demonstrated work and may count as relevant experience, while remaining truthfully labelled.
- The exact final text and documents approved for submission are versioned and retained.
- Submission remains manual on the original employer or freelance platform.

ACCURACY RULE

AI may organize and draft from approved facts. It must not invent experience, credentials, work, availability, pricing, results, or commitments.

Step 7 - Freelance pricing and approval controls

FINALIZED

Proposal pricing

Proposal pricing means the amount and payment structure quoted to a freelance client. It may include hourly or fixed-price pricing, estimated hours, total project price, deposit, milestone payments, and approved complexity or rush adjustments.

First-release pricing rule

- Pricing is entered manually for each freelance opportunity.
- Saved rate rules and automatic price recommendations are postponed.
- JobQuest never promises or sends a price without the user's approval.
- The approved price and assumptions are stored with the final proposal version.

Preparation workflow

Order	Action
1	Load the posting, approved Candidate Profile version, and Step 5 evaluation.
2	Select only relevant confirmed experience, skills, achievements, and project evidence.
3	Generate a draft when the user requests AI assistance.
4	Show source evidence beside each material claim and clearly mark gaps or questions.
5	User edits and approves the content, attachments, answers, availability, and freelance price.
6	Generate final PDFs and freeze a versioned application package.
7	User submits manually and records submission in Step 8.

Acceptance criteria

- A package cannot be finalized without the mandatory Candidate Profile documents.
- Every material claim traces to confirmed evidence.
- Final PDFs are readable and versioned.
- The package requires explicit user approval before it is marked final.
- No application, proposal, answer, price, or commitment is sent automatically.

Step 8 - Application and response tracking

FINALIZED

PURPOSE	BEGINS WITH	ENDS WITH	PRIMARY CONTROL
Record submission, follow-up, communication, interviews, assessments, and outcomes.	An application or proposal is submitted manually	The opportunity reaches a recorded outcome	Manual updates plus reminders

Core statuses

Status	Meaning
Prepared	Package is final but not yet submitted.
Applied / Proposal Sent	Submitted through the original platform.
Response Received	Employer or client replied; the response is entered manually.
Interview / Meeting	Track the applicable sub-status.
Assessment	Track the applicable assessment sub-status.
Follow-up Due	A user-approved follow-up should be considered.
Offer Received / Won	An employment offer or freelance win was received.
Rejected / Lost	The opportunity ended unsuccessfully.
No Response	The follow-up window passed without a response.
Withdrawn	The user stopped pursuing the opportunity.

Tracking rules

- Responses and communication are entered manually in the first release; automatic email importing is postponed.
- Suggest a follow-up 14 days after submission.
- Reminders never send a message automatically.
- Store submission date, platform, final files/text, contact details, events, notes, next action, and full status history.
- Employment can close in Step 8. A freelance win is recorded here and may later continue into the deferred Step 9 workflow.

Step 8 - Interview, assessment, and outcomes

FINALIZED

Interview sub-statuses

Status	Use
Invited	An invitation was received.
Scheduling	Dates are being coordinated.
Scheduled	A date and time are confirmed.
Completed	The interview occurred.
Next Round	Another interview stage is expected.
Awaiting Decision	The employer/client is deciding.
Cancelled	The event was cancelled.

Assessment sub-statuses

Status	Use
Requested	An assessment was assigned.
Not Started	Available but work has not begun.
In Progress	Work has begun.
Submitted	Delivered to the employer/client.
Passed	Successful result received.
Failed	Unsuccessful result received.
Expired / Withdrawn	No longer active.

Employment outcomes

- Offer Received; Offer Accepted; Offer Declined; Rejected; Withdrawn; No Response.
- When an offer is accepted, mark the opportunity Accepted Employment and record employer, position, acceptance date, and start date when known.
- A separate employment-onboarding record is not part of the first release.

Acceptance criteria

- Every submission retains the exact approved package and submitted date.
- The 14-day follow-up date is calculated and can be adjusted by the user.
- Status and sub-status histories are preserved.
- Accepted employment closes successfully without creating an onboarding record.
- A freelance win remains ready for the future Step 9 expansion.

First-release completion and handoff

IMPLEMENTATION BASELINE

Steps 1-8 are complete for requirements-review purposes. Coding begins only after these requirements are translated into pages, data structures, architecture, development phases, and tests.

Cross-cutting requirements

Area	Requirement
Human control	No automatic application, proposal, message, acceptance, price promise, or publication.
Ownership and privacy	Every private record is scoped to its owner; discovery prompts exclude sensitive personal data.
Source integrity	Original imports and submitted packages remain immutable evidence; working copies and later versions are separate.
Explainability	Scores, recommendations, matches, and claims show their evidence, rules, gaps, and versions.
Auditability	Imports, edits, merges, decisions, approvals, status changes, archives, restores, and deletions are logged.
Graceful failure	Parser, email, AI, PDF, and reminder failures remain visible and recoverable without silent data loss.
Token efficiency	Routine work uses application code. AI is reserved for per-opportunity evaluation and approved drafting.
No fabricated targets	The system reports actual valid discovery counts and never claims the five-opportunity target was met when it was not.

Deferred Steps 9-14

Step	Reserved stage	Current status
9	Client requirements and scope	Deferred until Steps 1-8 are implemented and reviewed
10	Convert freelance win into project	Deferred
11	Project delivery and progress	Deferred
12	Client review and approval	Deferred
13	Publishing and handoff	Deferred
14	Analytics and improvement	Deferred

The deferred names reserve the existing lifecycle numbering. They are not implementation requirements in this finalized first-release plan and will receive their own requirements review later.

Addendum - Future crucial features

CONTINUATION RULE

After the reserved Steps 9-14, any newly approved crucial workflow feature continues sequentially as Step 15, Step 16, Step 17, and so on. Existing step numbers are not renumbered.

Purpose

This addendum preserves a controlled place for major capabilities discovered after the current plan. It prevents unreviewed ideas from silently entering the first-release scope while allowing the JobQuest lifecycle to grow without rewriting the approved steps.

When a new numbered step is justified

- The feature introduces a distinct workflow stage with its own beginning, end, user outcome, data, permissions, and acceptance criteria.
- It materially affects how JobQuest discovers, evaluates, applies, tracks, delivers, publishes, or improves work.
- It is too significant to be handled as a field, validation, status, reminder, or small enhancement inside an existing step.
- Its requirements have been reviewed and approved before implementation.

Required format for every future step

Section	Required content
Step number and name	Continue from Step 15 without renumbering prior steps.
Purpose	State the user outcome and why the stage exists.
Begins / ends	Define the entry condition and completion state.
Primary control	Identify user, application code, AI-assisted, or hybrid control.
Workflow	List the ordered actions and status transitions.
Data and permissions	Define records, ownership, sensitive data, and versioning.
Human-control boundary	State what cannot happen without explicit approval.
Failure handling	Define visible, recoverable error behavior.
Acceptance criteria	Provide objective tests that close the requirements review.
Dependencies	Identify prior steps, services, and migrations required.

Future-step register

Step	Feature	Approval state
15	Reserved for the next approved crucial feature	Not yet proposed
16	Reserved for a later approved crucial feature	Not yet proposed
17+	Continue sequentially as needed	Not yet proposed

Addendum control

A future idea remains an idea until its requirements are approved and this addendum is revised. Adding a future step does not reopen or alter Steps 1-8 unless the change explicitly requires a versioned amendment to those requirements.